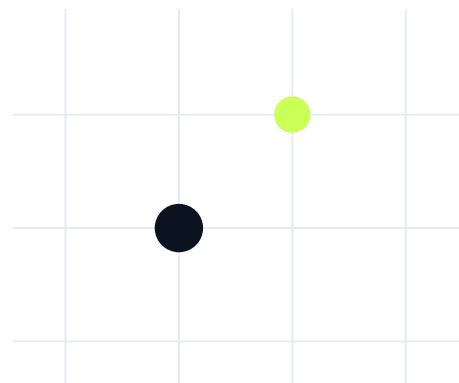


AI READY COLOMBO

Practical AI skills for a changing world.



AI PRIVACY QUICK GUIDE

Know what you are sharing before you press send.

Some information does not belong in a prompt

AI tools are easy to use because you can paste almost anything into them. That convenience can make it easy to share more than you meant to. Before uploading a file, screenshot or conversation, look at what is actually inside it.

Usually lower-risk

Public information
Generic or fictional examples
Non-sensitive notes
Content you are already comfortable sharing

Pause before sharing

Names, IDs or contact details
Confidential workplace documents
Client or customer information
Financial or payment details
Passwords, keys or login data
Private health, research or conversation data

If sharing it with the wrong person would create a problem, pause before uploading it.

These are not the same setting

AI products often separate history, memory, model improvement and feedback. Turning one off does not automatically turn the others off.

CHAT HISTORY	Keeps a record of your conversations so you can return to them later.
MEMORY / PERSONALISATION	Lets the product use information from past interactions to tailor future responses.
MODEL IMPROVEMENT	Controls whether eligible conversations may be used to improve or train the provider's models.
FEEDBACK	Thumbs-up, thumbs-down or bug reports can follow separate data rules and may include conversation context.

For university or workplace information, your organisation's policy comes first. A paid account or a request such as 'do not save this' does not automatically make confidential data safe to upload.

Know what your AI tool is doing with your chats

The names and menus change over time, but the basic question is the same: what is saved, what is remembered, and what can be used to improve the model?

ChatGPT

Check: Settings > Data controls > Improve the model for everyone. Memory controls are under Settings > Personalization.

Turning model improvement off stops new personal chats from being used to train OpenAI models. Temporary Chat can be useful when you do not want the conversation to use or create memory.

Claude

Check: Settings > Privacy > Help Improve our AI models.

For consumer Claude accounts, turning this off stops new chats and coding sessions from being used for future model training. Incognito chats are not used to improve Claude.

Gemini

Check: Open Gemini Apps Activity and review Keep Activity. Temporary Chat is available for one-off conversations.

With Keep Activity off, future chats are not used to train Google's AI models unless you choose to submit feedback. Google still retains some chats briefly for service and safety needs.

Microsoft Copilot

Check: Profile > Privacy > Training on conversation activity. Memory is separate under Profile > Memory > Personalization and memory.

You can opt out of model training while keeping personalization on. Conversation history and memory are separate controls.

Before sharing anything sensitive

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| ☐ | Is this allowed by my university, workplace or organisation? |
| ☐ | Can I remove names, IDs, account numbers or other identifying details? |
| ☐ | Can I describe the situation instead of uploading the original file? |
| ☐ | Have I checked the current privacy and model-improvement settings? |
| ☐ | Would I still be comfortable sharing this if it were retained or reviewed under the provider's policy? |

Privacy settings reduce risk. They do not replace good judgment about what you choose to share.